of Pakistani security, its focus of physical jihad remained IHK. It embraced a pan-Islamic rationale for military action. It did not support revolutionary jihad at home because the struggle in Pakistan 'was not a struggle between Islam and disbelief'. According to the LeT tract Why We Do Jihad, 'if we declare war against those who have professed Faith, we cannot do war with those who haven't'. Instead, the group seeks gradual reform through *dawa*. The aim is to bring the people of Pakistan to LeT's interpretation of Ahl-e-Hadith Islam and, by doing so, to transform the society in which they live (Jamestown Foundation, 2012). Because of this, the Pakistani state rewarded JuD/LeT with preferential treatment, which the group leveraged during that period and remained unfettered. Hafiz Saeed resigned as the Amir of LeT, assumed control of JuD and announced that all Lashkar activities and offices had been shifted to IHK. He responded to both international and internal pressures tactfully by disassociating itself from LeT.

JuD/LeT despite being known for having links with Al Qaeda did not pose a threat to Pakistan. It was considered a dreaded force detrimental to the interests of India and later on to some extent to the US; however, within Pakistan, it had no record of anti-state activity. Even after the Mumbai attacks, it gradually receded and restricted itself to vitriolic rhetoric against India and angry outburst against the US and seemed to be desirous of becoming a political party.

## LeT'S INVOLVEMENT IN THE MUMBAI INCIDENT

LeT was held responsible for the terrorist attacks on Mumbai in November 2008. Ajmal Kasab, the only attacker captured alive, was sentenced to death by Indian courts in May 2010 and hanged in 2013. The role of state and ISI in this incident was also questioned by India. The then Indian Prime Minister also blamed the 'agencies' in Pakistan.

Pakistan strongly denied the allegations of India against it. Furthermore, it argued that if Kasab was a Pakistani citizen, it was not enough to blame the state and ISI for training, planning or execution of this attack. Pakistan arrested Hafiz Saeed but the court released him due to insufficient evidence. India termed it a subterfuge. The fact remained that the anti-terrorism courts were already hearing prosecution arguments against the seven men captured in November 2009 for their